

The Community Engagement Project Report
For Bachelors of Arts/Commerce/Science Degree

“Agrarian Sector”
(Promote Organic Farming)

Submitted to



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“Name of the Department”
New Arts, Commerce and Science College, Ahmednagar
(Autonomous)

In

“Bachelor of Computer Science”

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Ahmednagar Jilha Maratha Vidya Prasarak Samaj's
NEW ARTS, COMMERCE AND SCIENCE COLLEGE
AHMEDNAGAR
(Autonomous)



DEPARTMENT OF COMPUTER SCIENCE

CERTIFICATE

This is to certify that the work incorporated in the community engagemnet project report on “**Agrarian Sector**” submitted bystudent of New Arts, Commerce and Science College, Ahmednagar, (Autonomous) is submitted in the partial requirement for the Bachelor's Degree.

Project Guide
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ACKNOWLEDGMENT

We extend our sincere gratitude to all individuals and organizations who contributed to the success of our Community Engagement Project on Promoting Organic Farming. This initiative would not have been possible without the dedication, collaboration, and support of various stakeholders committed to sustainable agriculture and education.

We deeply appreciate the efforts of farmers, agricultural experts, and environmental advocates who shared their knowledge and expertise in organic farming. Your guidance has been instrumental in educating communities about eco-friendly farming techniques, soil health, and sustainable food production.



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INTRODUCTION

❖ Origin of the Problem

Agriculture is the backbone of our economy, but excessive use of chemical fertilizers and pesticides has led to soil degradation, water pollution, and health issues. This has resulted in lower crop yields, reduced soil fertility, and increased farmer dependency on costly chemical inputs.

Organic farming is an alternative that preserves soil health, enhances biodiversity, and provides healthier food. However, many farmers lack awareness, training, and market access, making it difficult for them to transition to organic farming.

The increasing use of chemical fertilizers and pesticides in conventional farming has led to severe environmental damage, loss of soil fertility, and harmful impacts on human health. There is a pressing need to shift towards more sustainable practices like organic farming.

❖ Aim and Objectives

Aim:-

- To promote organic farming among farmers by raising awareness, providing practical training, and supporting their transition from conventional to organic practices.
- Sustainable Agriculture – Promote eco-friendly farming practices that maintain soil fertility and biodiversity.
- Healthy Food Production – Ensure the availability of chemical-free, nutritious, and safe food.
- Environmental Conservation – Reduce pollution, conserve water, and protect natural ecosystems.
- Economic Growth of Farmers – Improve farmers' income by reducing input costs and increasing market value.
- Climate Change Mitigation – Minimize carbon footprint by avoiding synthetic chemicals and promoting carbon sequestration.

Objectives:-

- Educate farmers about the harmful effects of chemical-based farming.
- Train them in natural fertilizers, composting, and biological pest control.
- Introduce government schemes and organic certification processes.
- Help farmers establish market linkages for selling organic produce.
- Encourage the use of natural fertilizers and pesticides (e.g., compost, bio-fertilizers, and neem-based pesticides).
- Promote crop rotation, intercropping, and companion planting to enhance soil health and pest control.
- Support organic certification and labeling to ensure consumer trust and market growth.

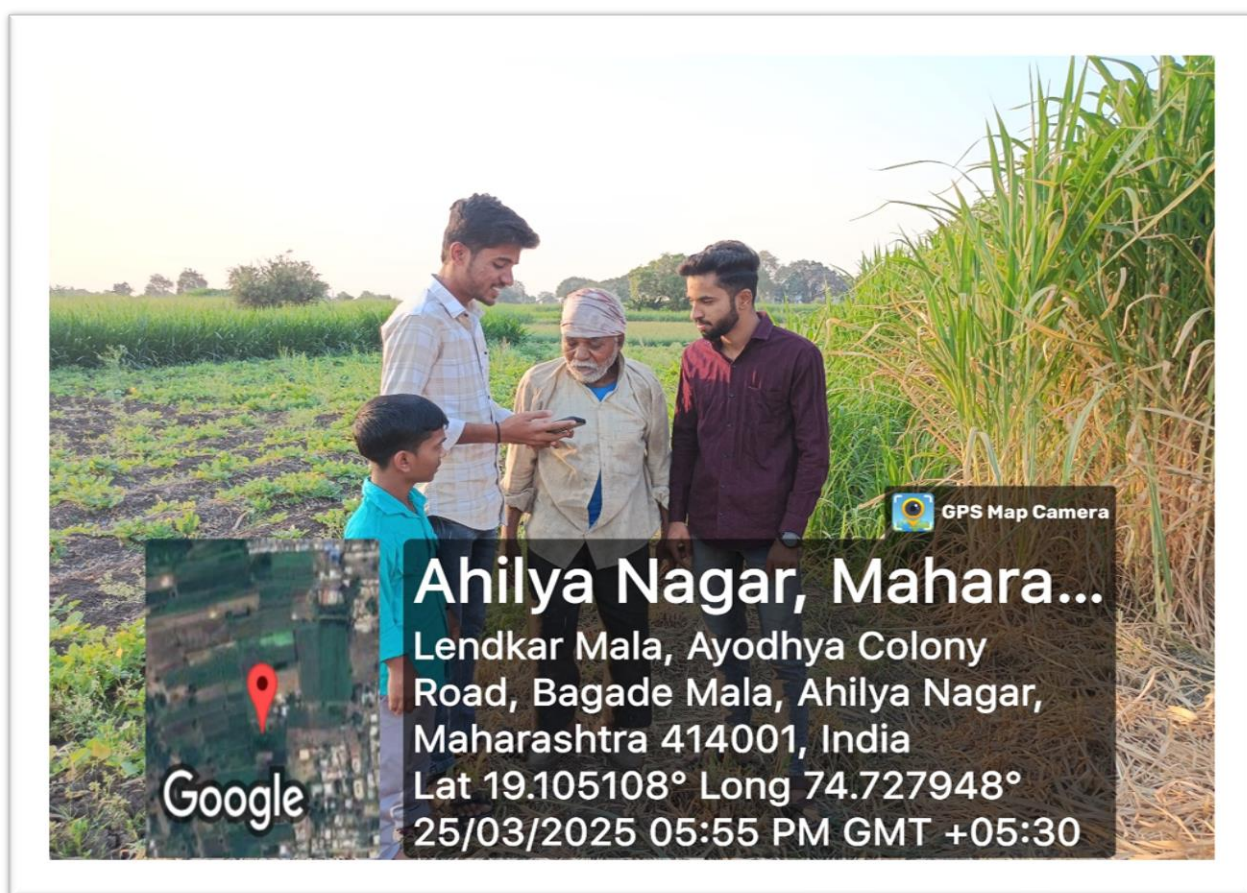
METHODOLOGIES

1. Survey & Data Collection:

- Conducted field visits and interviews with farmers.
- Collected data on their current farming methods, challenges, and awareness of organic farming.

2. Awareness Campaigns:

- Discussions and Farmers meetings.
- Distributed pamphlets and posters to spread awareness.
- Used social media to reach a wider audience.



3. Workshops & Training Sessions:

- Conducted practical demonstrations on:
- Vermicomposting (organic compost from earthworms)
- Jeevamrut & Dashparni Ark (natural fertilizers and pesticides)
- Crop rotation & mixed cropping techniques

4. Field Visits & Farmer Interactions:

- Organized trips to model organic farms.
- Enabled farmers to interact with successful organic practitioners

5. Market Linkages & Certification Guidance:

- Provided information on organic certification procedures.
- Connected farmers with local organic markets and online selling platforms.
- Guided them on government subsidies for organic farming

6. Organic Certification and Market Linkage

- Educate farmers about organic certification processes (e.g., USDA Organic, India Organic).
- Establish direct farmer-to-consumer markets and online organic stores.
- Create awareness campaigns to promote organic food consumption.

7. Sustainable Farming Techniques

- Promote permaculture and agroforestry for long-term sustainability.
- Encourage zero-budget natural farming (ZBNF) to reduce costs.
- Integrate beekeeping and aquaculture for biodiversity and productivity.



RESULT AND DISCUSSION

❖ Results:-

1. Improved Soil Fertility & Health

- Chemical fertilizers degrade soil quality, whereas organic farming increases organic matter, which benefits soil health.
- Using organic fertilizers (compost, vermicompost, and green manure) enhances microbial activity in the soil, making nutrients more available.

2. Reduction in Water and Soil Pollution

- Chemical pesticides and fertilizers cause water pollution, whereas organic farming keeps groundwater and soil cleaner.
- Organic practices improve soil salinity and percolation capacity, leading to better water retention and conservation.



3. Healthier and Nutrient-Rich Food

- Organic products are free from chemical residues, reducing the risk of cancer, heart disease, and other health issues.
- Studies show that organic food contains higher levels of antioxidants, vitamins, and minerals, making it more beneficial for human health.

4. Conservation of Biodiversity

- Chemical farming harms beneficial soil microorganisms, earthworms, and pollinators like butterflies and bees.
- Organic farming supports natural ecosystems, encouraging bird populations, honeybees, and wild species conservation.



5. Economic Benefits for Farmers

- Organic products fetch higher market prices, increasing farmers' profits and income.
- The use of organic fertilizers reduces dependency on synthetic fertilizers and pesticides, lowering overall farming costs.

6. Positive Impact on Climate Change

- Organic farming helps sequester carbon in the soil, reducing greenhouse gas emissions.
- Unlike synthetic fertilizers, which require large amounts of energy for production, organic farming is energy-efficient.

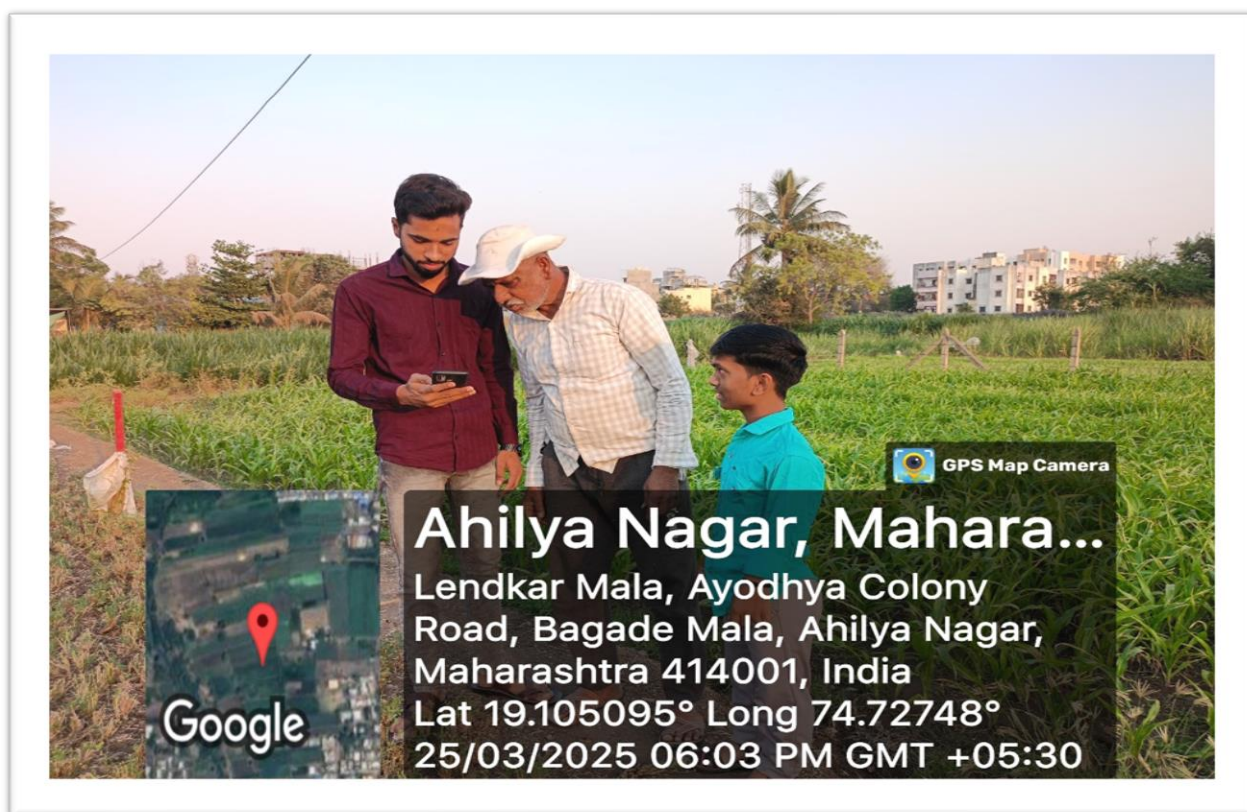
Discussion :

1. Environmental Benefits:

- Reduces chemical runoff and pollution by avoiding synthetic pesticides and fertilizers.
- Enhances soil health through natural composting, crop rotation, and biodiversity.
- Promotes carbon sequestration, helping mitigate climate change.

2. Health Benefits:

- Produces healthier food free from harmful pesticides and synthetic chemicals.
- Supports nutrient-rich crops, which may have higher levels of antioxidants and vitamins.
- Reduces the risk of antibiotic resistance by avoiding antibiotics in livestock.



3. Economic Opportunities:

- Provides a niche market with growing consumer demand for organic products.
- Encourages sustainable rural development through small-scale farming.
- Can command higher prices, leading to better profitability for farmers.

4. Sustainability:

- Maintains soil fertility over the long term through natural methods.
- Encourages biodiversity, improving ecosystem resilience

5. Policy Support and Education:

- Importance of government incentives and subsidies for organic farmers.
- Need for awareness campaigns to educate consumers about the benefits of organic farming.

6. Public Awareness Campaigns:

- Promote the benefits of organic farming through media, community programs, and educational materials.
- Highlight the health, environmental, and economic benefits of organic products.

6. Use of Gobar in Farming

Natural Fertilizer: Gobar is rich in nitrogen, phosphorus, and potassium, which improve soil health.

Improves Soil Structure: Enhances water retention and aeration.

Eco-friendly Pest Control: Acts as a natural pesticide when mixed with neem or other organic materials.

Cost-effective: Reduces the need for chemical fertilizers.



RECOMMENDATIONS

1. Increased Financial Support:

- Provide subsidies, grants, and low-interest loans to organic farmers to reduce production costs.
- Create insurance schemes that protect organic farmers against crop failure.

2. Research and Development:

- Invest in research to improve organic farming techniques and develop resistant crop varieties.
- Promote indigenous knowledge integration with scientific research.

3. Training and Education:

- Organize workshops, training programs, and certifications to educate farmers about organic practices.
- Incorporate organic farming topics into school and college curricula.

4. Improving Market Access:

- Establish more local and international organic markets.
- Promote e-commerce platforms dedicated to organic produce.

5. Policy Support:

- Implement favorable policies and regulations to encourage organic farming.
- Develop strict guidelines for labeling organic products to maintain consumer trust.

6. Public Awareness Campaigns:

- Promote the benefits of organic farming through media, community programs, and educational materials.
- Highlight the health, environmental, and economic benefits of organic products.

8. Encouraging Sustainable Practices:

- Promote crop rotation, composting, and natural pest control methods.
- Discourage the use of harmful chemicals and promote natural alternatives.

9. Building Farmer Cooperatives:

- Encourage organic farmers to form cooperatives for collective bargaining and knowledge sharing.
- Provide platforms for sharing experiences and resources.

CONCLUSION

In conclusion, promoting organic farming is essential for building a sustainable future. By encouraging environmentally friendly practices, preserving biodiversity, and ensuring healthier food production, organic farming offers a viable solution to many of the challenges posed by conventional agriculture.

It supports soil health, reduces chemical pollution, and promotes ecological balance.

Additionally, investing in organic farming can boost local economies and enhance food security. Therefore, stakeholders, including governments, farmers, consumers, and organizations, must work collaboratively to adopt and support organic farming practices for a healthier planet and future generations.



